

Reza Max Azimi

Quality Compliance | cGMP Quality Specialist | Auditing | Quality Management | Quality Assurance

Canadian Citizen | Based in the Netherlands | Available for immediate U.S. or Canada relocation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality compliance, quality assurance, and auditing specialist with 15 years of experience leading cGMP, FDA, and EU GMP regulatory compliance across pharmaceutical, biotech, sterile, and API manufacturing, including nine years at Merck and Organon.

Accomplished in leading FDA inspection readiness, audit management, supplier management, CAPA governance, QMS governance, risk management, deviation management, and change control. Experienced in cross-functional regulatory compliance and risk-based oversight in highly regulated manufacturing.

SKILLS

- **Regulatory Compliance:** FDA, GxP, cGMP, 21 CFR 210 and 211, EudraLex, EU GMP Annex 1, ICH Q9 and Q10
- **Auditing:** Internal Audits, Supplier Audits, Inspection Readiness, Regulatory Audits, CAPA Governance
- **Quality Systems:** Data Integrity, QMS Governance, Change Control, Quality Risk Management, Supplier Management, Complaint Management, Deviation Management, Training and Qualification
- **Other Skills:** Regulatory Impact Assessment, Project Management, TrackWise, Veeva, SAP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quality Compliance and Auditing Specialist

Organon – Oss, Netherlands | July 2025–Present

MSD (Merck) Biotech – Oss, Netherlands | November 2018–June 2025

Manage cGMP inspection readiness, internal audits, CAPA, QMS oversight, quality council, supplier oversight, QA approvals, change control, CMC & regulatory support, and quality risk management.

- Lead internal audits and inspection readiness, resulting in zero FDA inspection findings and no critical findings across five regulatory audits.
- Execute 6+ cGMP audits per month across operational areas, reducing repeat deviations through auditee coaching and sustained compliance oversight.
- Perform CAPA governance and approve effectiveness verifications, strengthening inspection readiness and reducing repeat audit findings.
- Conduct 15+ change control impact assessments annually to align with regulatory requirements and reduce quality and patient safety risks.
- Champion QRM by leading 8+ risk assessments annually and expanding team capability by training three risk specialists, strengthening risk-based decision making.
- Governed nine quality management systems, maintaining FDA and regulatory compliance and reducing QMS escalations to zero through continuous improvement.
- Spearheaded two cross-functional QMS projects, transitioning to ICH Q10 and Organon standards while coordinating and supervising 40 specialists to mitigate gaps on schedule.

Quality Compliance and Systems Associate

MSD (Merck) Animal Health – Boxmeer, Netherlands | June 2017–October 2018

Steered the internal audits, supplier quality management, supplier audit execution, and supplier approval.

- Led external audits at five European suppliers and CMOs, identified critical compliance gaps, and drove CAPA closures to reduce supplier quality risks.
- Trained one auditor and executed 4+ annual audits to expand audit capacity and sustain inspection readiness.
- Developed a risk-based audit plan that prioritized higher-risk suppliers to focus audit resources and sustain audit plan compliance.

- Maintained supplier records and the approved suppliers list to strengthen supplier oversight and approval controls in line with quality requirements.

Quality Assurance Specialist

Royal FrieslandCampina – Veghel, Netherlands | June 2016–May 2017

Strengthened food safety and quality management systems through risk-based auditing, FSSC 22000 readiness, complaint management, and cross-functional quality improvements (Food, Feed GMP+, Pharma Excipients).

- Implemented a risk-based audit program, led four internal audits annually, and drove CAPA closure to improve compliance readiness and strengthen the food safety program.
- Coordinated mock recalls and traceability validations to improve compliance preparedness and support a successful FSSC 22000 recertification.
- Collaborated with production, supply chain, engineering, and operations to identify food safety risks and implement preventive measures across functions.
- Optimized the complaint management system by streamlining investigation and resolution efficiency to improve on-time closure rates.
- Facilitated root cause investigations and corrective actions for complaints, audit findings, and quality events to reduce issue recurrence.

Food Safety and Quality Specialist Consultant

Food Technology Consulting International – Toronto, Canada | May 2015–April 2016

Consulted and supported manufacturing and distribution enterprises through regulatory compliance guidance, quality system implementation, training, and certification readiness across HACCP, BRCGS, and SQF standards.

- Delivered consulting and training across 11 enterprises to improve food safety and regulatory compliance and support successful quality system implementation.
- Managed quality compliance by advising on deviations, validations, changes, and certification readiness.

Regulatory Affairs Coordinator and Quality Assurance Technician

Protenergy Natural Foods Corporation – Toronto, Canada | November 2011–January 2014

Supported supplier compliance, FDA/USDA/CFIA compliance, product safety, Non-Conformance Reporting, and quality control for Tetra Pak food manufacturing operations.

- Coordinated FDA/USDA/CFIA supplier compliance and product quality testing, supporting 500+ supplier approvals and timely product release through raw material analysis, final product testing, and root cause closures.

EDUCATION

- **Associate Degree – Biotechnology and Industrial Microbiology**, Centennial College – Toronto, Canada
- **Bachelor of Science B.Sc. Coursework – Biological Sciences**, University of Toronto – Toronto, Canada

CERTIFICATIONS

- **ISO 9001:2015**, PJR – 2026
- **Good Clinical Practice GCP**, FGCP – 2026
- **Quality Risk Management Champion**, Merck – 2024
- **GMP Auditor**, ECA – 2017
- **Pharmaceutical GMP**, NSF – 2017
- **Cleanroom GMP**, Merck – 2017
- **Data Integrity**, Merck – 2017
- **HACCP & GMP**, Ontario College of Technology – 2013
- **Quality Assurance & Quality Control**, Tetra Pak – 2013